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Virginia Board of Education, Business Meeting, Thursday, January 25, 2024

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2ZNsCKiGf4w
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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[00:00:18] It's 9 o'clock, and I would like to call this meeting to order. I don't think we're going to have anyone remotely participating today, so there's no need for that remark. But what I would like to do first very good.

[00:00:49] So as is customary for the board, we'd like to begin with a moment of silence, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance.

[00:01:12] Okay, I would like to take a moment to turn it over to Dr. Coons for just one minute for an introduction.

[00:01:37] Well, I just want to say thank you for the Library of Virginia for hosting us in the event. I don't know how many of you know this, but on Tuesday morning, team members started showing up at the James Monroe building at 6 a.m. and we had no power and we had no power all day and we wanted to make sure that we could continue the continuity of operations toward the state board to make sure they had the opportunity the library of virginia came to all aid which is divided us all the texts apart all the space involved with everything we need and able to ask everyone at the same time

[00:02:15] I'm so excited to welcome the new Librarian of Virginia, Dennis Clark, on his very first day at the 10th Library of Virginia. He comes to us from the Library of Congress, where he was the Chief of

Research, Engagement, and General Collection. He was a significant experience

[00:02:44] Virginia. Would you like to say a few words? Thank you, Dr. Kearns. It is indeed my pleasure to welcome you because this meeting here at the Library of Virginia, we're very happy that we've been able to provide that support for you when heldings sometimes don't cooperate. As Dr. Kearns said, today is an auspicious day for the library. It begins our third century, having been founded

[00:03:19] on January 24th 1823 and again my this day is my first day I'm supposed to be in my HR orientation but instead I wasn't able to bring anything out because I don't have access to a printer so I'm reading off my phone here but again it is my great pleasure as Dr. Kitt said I was directly from the Library of Congress but I was also I worked in library administration at both BCU and

[00:03:54] UVA for about a decade between 2011. Virginia is an amazing institution. The Library of Virginia, as it starts its third century, I went and took a quick look. It's 80 years older than the Department of Education, so it seemed like an interesting connection to the library. Like the Department of Ed has been actively engaged with making sure students and teachers around the state have been uh understanding primary sources understanding virginia's history

[00:04:32] stories uh and that is certainly the mission that we have it is in preserving those stories uh that we find ourselves probably our most solemn um asset of what we do here at the library of virginia um that preservation stories that making those stories available digitally is what we strive to do, and how we know that we are with church educators and students around the Commonwealth.

[00:05:03] And it's because we've been doing this for the last 200 years or so that we have had the opportunity to have a positive influence not only on our own Commonwealth, but on the way that stories are preserved throughout the globe. The Library of Virginia is a leader in terms of practices and policies available and ensuring that those stories, our documents, the stories are made available. A particular interest to this body is our engagement with teachers

[00:05:41] about today's students. You may know that the library is home to the Brown Teacher Researcher Fellowship, which offers your fellowships, studies in history, to be able to use the library collections and to turn those into... we work with them, we collaborate with them as well, Well, in this last summer, the teacher fellowships have focused on the schools that are not particularly the ones that we hear in our own history, ones that are either hidden or neglected from

[00:06:16] the mainstream narratives, and that's a great thing that we get to do to uncover them. In addition to the library from this last summer, the last two schools, a teacher-edition institutes in all of the eight regions of the state as part of the Brown Teacher Edition.

[00:06:35] The library also publishes a significant number of resources digitally, so people around the Commonwealth can access the Library of Virginia's collections. They don't have to actually be here in Richmond.

[00:06:51] educators and researchers and as we look for a renovation project of this space first students and even more um i'll close with this promise as um the newest employer the commonwealth in the room uh that the library will continue to connect with virginia students teachers in order to bring their creativity and their fresh eyes perspective onto the documents and the stories that we have have been stewarding over the last 200 years and continue to steward as they are created.

[00:07:28] Thank you again. - We are very excited in the educational community to have you and to have you partner with the department. And we look forward as we are working through many sets of standards and professional development.

[00:07:47] Dr. Sorensen in the back as our deputy of teaching and learning, we are really looking forward to partnering with you. Welcome to Virginia. I don't want to hear the approval of the agenda. Is there a motion to move on?

[00:08:15] Aye. Aye. And chair votes on. Um, staff is provided with the board with the draft minutes before the meeting. Is there a motion to move on?

[00:08:33] So moved. I'd like to propose a substitute motion. Uh, I'd like to clarify, amend to clarify one item on the minutes. If I may, shall I make my substitute motion now?

[00:08:50] is that the right process sure i move that we amend that we approve the amendments with one change that in the final paragraph of item d which is the soq prescriptions there was well let me just by way of background there was some confusion about the language on the at-risk add-on and uh had a recommendation written up incorrectly and then i made a verbal motion both the minutes referred to the ratio one which I think would be the outdated written

[00:09:24] version so increases my motion to clarify instead of saying please minute say made a motion to approve prescription as amended to include recommendation one and to remove the cost test instead of that language I would say made a motion to leave prescription g as amended to read as follows and I would quote from the document which is posted on the website which accurately reflects that amendment as follows or recommends the general assembly consolidate the at-risk

[00:10:02] add-on program and the prevention and education program get a new at-risk program under the standards of quality at-risk program would be allocated based on each school division's weighted identified student percentage and 60 percent of funding would be distributed to divisions using a per student rate 40 percent would be distributed using a variable rate based

[00:10:24] Dr. Siebert. Aye. Aye. Aye. As stated the board's bylaws, it is the pleasure of the board to accept public comment on all matters related to public education in Virginia.

[00:11:08] If the public would like to provide us with any comment, we do ask that you provide your name and affiliation at the beginning of your comments.

[00:11:16] I was wondering whether the technology would follow us today and we have they are amazing so you're going to see the screen is three minutes and then two minutes or sorry one minute it turns yellow and then as your time starts ticking down the screen will be turning red so if you have any

[00:11:50] the door to provide those um perfect so at this time our first is good morning everybody president creasy dr coons and members of the board of education my name is scott raybrand i'm executive director for the virginia association of school superintendents i'm here to comment

[00:12:27] on a couple of items before you both today and yesterday in your work session first item the accountability model feedback keep the equal growth weighting but also keep the graduation completion index or GCI only support the equal weighting around growth and achievement of the elementary and the accountability model we're concerned though about the feedback of using only the federal graduation

indicator dropping and dropping the GCI for high school students the GCI which has served Virginia students for almost 20 years but eliminate the opportunity for some

[00:13:05] students to have other certified pass to graduation certified studies diploma for GED. Please keep the GCI as an indicator. Before you decide on assisting the score of percentages for identifying schools for support for comprehensive or targeted support out of CSI or TSI, assess right now how well the support you can have between VOE and I think that will help you.

[00:13:31] Those proper supports, neither approach that you would choose would be successful. Item two, decouple ELA and math standards implementation here, we applaud the new math standards and we applaud the new ELA standards that are before you. However, implementing new math and new ELA standards at the same time next year will overwhelm the workload of our teachers, particularly at elementary. The new ELA standards strategically align with VLA, the Virginia University Act, so So that really is the priority for next year, and we urge you to consider perhaps staggering standards out,

[00:14:11] remaining history and science standards, one each year, over three to four years. Really look and listen to it. And then finally, item three, share the SOL NAEP crosswalks and the dynamic instruction guides as soon as possible.

[00:14:29] I know the state superintendent says soon may actually be a day, so that's awesome. We applaud the work of crosswalking the new map and the LA standards. which has had a lot of attention teachers need to know those crosswalk need to have those crosswalk documents so they know what the sol standards are and what those play standards so we look forward to having them so they can begin to prepare we encourage to the rollout of the dynamic construction guides on this framework to help teachers do math standards so dr coons and our

[00:15:05] staff for continuing to collaborate with superintendents and us we look at continuing to work with our team in the months ahead. Happy New Year to all of you. Thank you.

[00:15:55] Thank you. So my name is Mary Ottenot, M-A-R-Y-O-T-T-I-N-O-T. I'm a registered nurse, been a nurse for about 14 years, and I'm originally from Chicago. I have three children who have disabilities, and it's what we consider twice exceptional. I am an IEP. I have specialties in psych, disabilities, pediatrics, geriatric, and I do also case management. My policy work

[00:16:34] Chicago that included Early Learning Council. I was part of the quality policy council. I also was one of the same parents at district leadership. And I also, the last initiative that I worked on was Every Child in Chicago. So, why am I here at the board today? Me, my children, and my family

[00:17:07] became victims of it's unfortunate that we have different things I've learned so much about the state of Virginia and currently the policy work I'm doing because I'm still committed to this work so the bad actors that were decided to make up everything under the sun

[00:17:47] and everybody was billing money in our names. My children tried to report that we're attached to our family. I asked for that. Nobody would report. What policies can we do? Understanding the difference here in Virginia that localities handle their own health level. What can we do at

[00:18:16] the state level to ensure safety? My children beg for that. Kelly Conrita, I remember seeing her in a different space and I asked her, is there anything that worked up? She didn't really just like the person we need better for our students but it's internal to the system thank

[00:18:51] you um are there any other members of the public here that we'd like to address the board during our public comment period but do not sign up on our website please come forward good morning my name is emily klein and i'm a resident of jesterfield county um an alumni of midlothian high school i have a sophomore at midlothian high school and i have an eighth grader at a

[00:19:29] a private school for students with language-based learning disabilities. I really wanted to just kind of address the problem that I'm seeing in schools. Kids aren't held accountable for their academics. Academic performance is rewarded for little effort. A worker is not there. A high schooler is not prepared for the future, and it falsely sets them up for the future thinking that they can put in little effort and gain reward. They're not held accountable for behavior. The

[00:20:08] fact that he comes home every day and there's this smell of marijuana throughout the halls, it's disturbing. Kids aren't held accountable for their behavior, which is why we don't have teachers. And they're not held accountable for behaviors. We're setting them up for failure in the future. They will be held accountable. And what will that look like? I know sometimes parents

[00:20:37] can be blind and defensive of their kids and not my child. But I see the same problem. VDOE protects the LEA. The LEA protects the individual school. So a lot of times we choose to be blind and get defensive. And I've seen that as an IEP mom. When there are problems in Chesterfield County with special education, I can have teachers tell you, I can't tell you this because the office

[00:21:13] told me not. But we can't do that in the office. And then you complain to the VDOE. Nobody responds or listens. Samantha Hollins covers up for people. What happened to Thomas Wilson? He was the one person with me. We spent five hours. Samantha Hollins told him to no longer speak to me and met with them privately to tell me this. He said they know that there's a problem with the hearing officers. They know there's a problem with the sexual education system, which is broken. They're

[00:21:50] not going to do anything about it. Go in and tell the superintendent, who wasn't here at the time, The governor, I will be fired, and you will be ignored. That's a problem still haven't received response.

[00:22:06] I know that we've seen class action loss.

[00:22:11] The video we come very protective parent, and so we need to stop protecting the establishment if we want the best part.

[00:23:01] One item of the second. Okay, is your first one? Aye.

[00:23:36] Can I even see the first review of recommendations for that? Final review of the recommendations of establishing advisory committee for learning. So at this time, Michelle, do you have anything to us?

[00:24:06] Yes. Good morning. good morning good morning are you this morning good welcome so we have for you an update we spoke to in december about transitioning for first review the junior advisory committee for

[00:24:34] education and gifted um this was you know for our needs um how currently um and has been historically um the big advisory board it doesn't reflect as we told you in december the needs of all of the advanced learners in the commonwealth of virginia and certainly does not provide new guidance on coverage school and gifted education and so we're closing the meeting of the cal the virginia

[00:25:09] advisory committee for advanced learning to assist with that work this is an overview of what we presented in december just that um we need so much broader um our schools are 22 sgs plus the seven residential advanced placement and you don't really have a committee that's focused on anything

[00:25:38] other than that um these are just the bylaws uh of the board that allow you to set the terms for those who are appointed for two years people cannot serve more than two consecutive firms and the bylaws allow you to dissolve and create the records as are needed so at the last meeting you all had um posed hey could you actually have a nationally recognized expert we took that into

[00:26:16] account and um changed it so this is a pathway to what we presented at 21 it still remains the same of having two per region which comprises ygs director some of the school outlooks on a breakdown

[00:26:50] um visually so you can just see that so that you can you can see um the the visual breakdown and And then we get to proportionality across the Commonwealth where previously we had very heavy representation in Region 4 and sparse representation in other locations across our superintendent regions.

[00:27:13] This is the recommended transition that we go. This was the other thing that you all brought to us.

[00:27:26] We're already already expired, but we said let's take rooms and whose roles align with the new BCAL mission to give you that broader insight and to help you with a greater body of work.

[00:27:58] And so that allows for stability in some respects and giving that institutional knowledge for those people to transition over. and then we would have the new numbers apply through the regular board method for terms that

[00:28:15] would since this is any current we could have current terms to go through June of next year on the other five are the expiring if it's expiring or already expired um of the five

[00:28:53] only four have votes which currently in law so that's the recommendation which works out to be about 20 percent of the new advisory these are some staggering so that it's not a completely new advisory it does provide the additional number which on robert's rules of order um

[00:29:27] rules of order it helps having a number and it allows for you all to be expanded this is what the carryover looks like about the positions so the region five you can six the region seven the region my computer can't be at the same time so that just is the visual overview of how the

[00:30:05] appointments get filled once the superintendent of public instruction recommends before the the final review to solve its Virginia advisory committee for a judicial gift advisory committee this morning and b ensure representation across the commonwealth on its new advisory committee by adopting a composition of two representatives per region one that is employee or administrator

[00:30:39] affiliated with gifted ed and or advanced academic programming and one parent plus one academic year governor, school director, representative, one private school gifted ed, and/or best academic programming representative, one superintendent, and the ex-officacy, no one questions.

[00:31:07] I don't want it a lot faster than me. Can you have any questions for Ms. Schultz? On slide 7, what I see is you're going to have 17 members appointed, so all their terms are going to expire. So hopefully, I don't know if there's a plan or idea, or maybe it can actually happen that some people don't do their full

their full terms but that could be a whole lot of turnover in 2027 it's an observation um you're not you're not wrong but it also it's inevitable

[00:31:41] that some people's terms won't um i think that balance of the four plus the means you have five people one affiliated with edoe plus four people out of cycle um we could if we find that down the road in 2027 that doesn't work um so you could have some stuff so i think it strikes the right

[00:32:08] balance well then just comment thank you for taking our input and made improvements oh good i'm glad we could listen to what you had to say and offer uh at the last meeting and incorporate your your opinions into this so that it reflects your needs dr coons thank you elizabeth i know this is your passion so i appreciate your dedicated focus and hard work on this it's much appreciated

[00:32:42] well i want to acknowledge um amanda navetrol who's our director of advanced learning she and kevin carr who was our specialist in this area have really helped put a lot of thought into this and done a lot of historical review as we get ready for some big changes on potential locations for videoe where we don't have transformers blow we have a major digitization project ahead of us because we don't really have a lot of things necessarily documented and so this took a lot of research on their point on their part along with um jim chapman to really look at the history

[00:33:21] of this committee that has kind of stayed the same for a long time and really bring you leaning in looking forward to the needs that this committee has to serve the advanced learning community and the common law further questions okay can i get a motion to approve the recommendation to dissolve the vcag and establish the virginia advisory committee for advanced learning and adopt the composition as recommended in the item mr sturdifant mr kilcourt uh miss ashton

[00:33:59] dr siebert dr northern hi miss holton hi thank you very much okay so we have first review uh proposal to stagger the terms for the early childhood advisory committee mr chapman President Creasy if it's acceptable on ways yes we know that during the session we must juggle

[00:34:36] and so and be flexible and we are going to do so so let me move on to item e final review of regular review of board of education that is document yes President Creasy members of the Board, Superintendent Koons. If I might before we begin, obviously moving the meeting location last minute put a lot of burdens on on you all, and certainly on on staff.

[00:35:07] But I was hoping just take a moment to recognize two of the individuals without whom this meeting would not be able to happen, and their unsung heroics should be sung at least once. Tim nut hall you know right behind you all in the other room in addition to scouting out two different locations on Tuesday and being out very late trying to make sure all the technology would work we're also right back you know six in the morning I think at this location yesterday and today making sure all the setup has happened they're just amazing and their level of professionalism

[00:35:43] is unmatched in my experience and it's going to say we are all very thankful to them for their work And they always are willing to do, they smile, anything that we have. Members of the board, we're also getting some notes about speaking into the mics.

[00:36:04] You have to kind of try and eat them a little bit. So we apologize for that, but thank you for your patience. The item that you have before is an item that you saw in first review back in December. And so we're bringing back to final review. If you don't mind, I'd like to just update you a little bit on what has happened since then.

[00:36:20] I believe at the suggestion of a few members of the board we went back and we've revised this list of documents that we're hoping to remove from the the list of guidance documents on all. For various reasons, some of which have expired, some of which we don't think the definition of a guidance document we've tried to provide much more robust and specific reasons for the removal, including noting which documents will continue to live on the video website.

[00:36:46] And we would like to also give our thanks to our friends at the Office of the Attorney General, Deb Love, Adam Kane, and Abby Gump, who we went through a very thorough review of all of these guidance documents, hundreds of pages and hours of their time spread over a couple of different meetings, making sure that there was, you know, complete accord that we think that these are okay to remove from town hall.

[00:37:13] In the interest of being very thorough in the review, our bar was very high. We have removed from that list a few of the items for different reasons. The license renewal manual, we are holding for further review because, as you know, there's some potential regulatory action on that topic.

[00:37:32] And the same thing with the high school partnerships guidelines and model liability that we think will bring that back to you individually. The physical education program guidelines, and we also think you might want a separate action, because there might be some other things to do.

[00:37:48] The student scholastic record, you might recall that you withdrew the final stage of the transcript action in December, and the policy regarding medication. that there's uh there might be a different we need to do that specifically but all the others we are in in very strong accord our um our documents as part of the cleanup and part of the service to the public to make sure they have the most recent up-to-date information um and that there is not conflicting guidance documents that are interpreting laws from back in 2006 um still on our registers

[00:38:22] okay so can i get a motion to introduce the local documents as identified in the stadium Mr. Sturdifant? Aye. Ms. Kilgore? Aye. Ms. Ashton? Aye. Dr. Siebert? Aye. Dr. Northern? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. And Chair votes off. Thank you.

[00:38:52] Madam President, before we move on, just by way of comment, I just want to thank both the AG's office, but also Mr. Chapman and team. And you all did go through, and I appreciate as to each item to note whether this is, some of them were old and some of them were adopted last year. And so So you've gone through and noted which ones are being removed because they're obsolete, and which ones are simply essentially being moved from town hall to the Doe website, because they don't need the definition of guidance but they're still alive and and appropriate and helpful to the

[00:39:28] divisions, and so I appreciate that clarification you went through on an item by item basis, and I think that greatly my understanding of the issues. So we're going to move on to item F, and that is the first review of proposed 2024 English standards of learning. Dr. Sorensen, are you coming up to give us presentations this morning?

[00:39:54] Sure. Are there any other questions other than what we discussed yesterday during our work session before we accept this item for first review? Dr. Siebert. I just, you know, I think that the great presentation we had yesterday, the deep dive into this, very appreciative. I think the standards are very, very strong.

[00:40:17] I think the connection here, though, comes back to our at the end of yesterday. We started talking about our work plan for the coming coming year, and this is where I think it's gonna be important to map out the implementation of a number of efforts, including the different different standards efforts that we have underway.

[00:40:36] but indeed i think the standards are great my concern is is about uh we can do anything well as teachers and school divisions it's very difficult to try to do everything well all at once so that's what he's going to be helpful um in terms of generalize are there comments or questions ms holton uh uh just for the sake of the public who may or may not have seen our discussion yesterday we did have a really terrific presentation and i refer folks back to that from Dr. Sorensen and a robust conversation about the English language

[00:41:13] arts standards and the bottom line is I think we're all very impressed with the high quality work that's gone into these standards and look forward to hearing from the public about them during our public hearings in the month of February with the hope that we'll be able to adopt final new standards in in March but we did have a lengthy discussion both about the content your presentation side by side helping us understand what's uh what are the differences was really terrific and so i encourage that those who weren't with us yesterday who are interested in this

[00:41:50] topic to take a look we also did have a robust discussion about the implementation issues online that the department is hoping to accelerate more than beyond what our normal process would be for the implementation of these which makes sense trying to align it with the mercy act but that that creates all kinds of challenges and that you all gave us some glimpse yesterday of your efforts to help address those challenges promised us more in march so uh with the public i'll look forward

[00:42:21] to that okay uh further questions or comments all right hearing none we will accept this item for first review thank you dr sports and we will move on to item g final review of the virginal literacy act um dr sorenson are you adding up the presentation and please proceed thank you

[00:42:52] okay i will um share this presentation with you um madam president thank you very much um board members thank you for having me this morning i appreciate it um and i will um bring back this item to the board um for final review um again i just wanted to ground us in the purpose of the um virginia's activision literacy plan um and the work that's been done over the past month

[00:43:25] to gather stakeholder engagement and feedback on this particular plan so stakeholder engagement following the board of education approval for first review um we have done quite a bit of work around engagement sessions we worked with the virginia literacy act group this is a specific group of stakeholders that have been working with the department over the past year this includes um division what we call architects um who really are academic officers executive directors of

[00:44:04] literacy teachers principals literacy experts throughout the commonwealth who have been working around vla implementation with the department over the past year and we also did focus sessions with superintendents thank you scott was in the audience and but we worked we partnered with vas to get very specific feedback from superintendents knowing that this really is about a superintendent's vision for what literacy and literacy instruction looks like

[00:44:39] at the division level knowing that superintendents have to sign off on the division literacy plan we thought it would be very important to engage with superintendents around instruction of this of the

plan and the contents of it we also worked with division level academic leaders and literacy super so these are um i won't read these to you but um we had multiple stakeholder engagement opportunities over the past month um to roll the plan out talk to stakeholders in the field whether it was superintendents whether it was executive directors whether it was teachers and whether it

[00:45:18] was principals to engage not only in what the plan is but how to develop the plan a lot of our conversations surprisingly went beyond just the plan itself there wasn't actually a ton of feedback on the plan and the template got into much more robust conversation similar to what we talk about here around the how right how are we doing the work what does this look like boots on the ground um conversations around differentiation right knowing that fairfax is going to have a different

[00:45:55] plan and roanoke city so we had conversation about the flexibility and that each one of our regions and each one of our school divisions will have in creating a plan so it was really great to be out in the field and the regions and also engaging with stakeholders around the plan and so here's some highlights that we've got um just again we bulleted them out um i'll start from the bottom up because the bottom up was good appreciating ease of the document appreciating addressing english language learners special education and gifted populations and appreciation

[00:46:33] for feedback um our our multiple feedback point that we got is that the timeline was tight and that it was challenging so you'll see in our final product that we adjust the timeline and that we have moved that attendance ease um but really um folks wanted inclusive language a mock-up to use as a guide comprehensive literacy plans versus vela implementation requirements folks wanted to know the specifics how specific did they have to get folks also wanted some latitude around revision

[00:47:11] if we grow throughout the process can we go back and change our plan can we go back and reiterate what it is that we're doing as we grow as a unit so and the answer is absolutely it's a continuous improvement process so our applied revisions based upon stakeholder feedback is the new submission date is june 3rd to address timeline feedback superintendents overwhelmingly were grateful that it was in june rather than in may knowing how busy may is for superintendents updated section

[00:47:45] three to include target audience an added date and year to allow for progress that was a sticking point for many of our superintendents expanded section 60 more inclusive of caregivers and community and the original document said parents and so we chose to have more inclusive language um created more spaces and boxes spaces and boxes were important and people wanted to ideate and and create and so we gave them more space to roam um but honestly the template didn't change much

[00:48:20] so what we've created um as an agency is an instruction guide talk more about the how rather than the what is the what the track was pretty clear thank you for this very clear clean template um we need more guidance on the how so we've created an instruction guide for our superintendents and the architects so again walking you through the plan here it is again for your review it one

[00:48:52] more time snapshot one here's the first page snapshot four boxes three and then the timeline for implementation you'll see that june 3rd um is the initial due date um approval of the plans that we're going to turn them around and give feedback by july 1st and when that first plan will be a one-year plan superintendents overwhelmingly as well as principals liked

[00:49:30] the opportunity for there to be a one-year plan knowing that in the first year we're going to learn a lot even divisions that have started already really felt that in their first year so much even in year

two it would be great to just have that first and then we'll go into um the 25 to 27 biennial plan that they'll submit um during the 20th following summer year plan then our next steps for support is to provide those instructions along with the release

[00:50:09] of the plan um host technical assistance for school division and leadership teams in the regions and we have an implementation plan set and where we will have these series implementation plans and that will help them complete their division literacy plans and there's four sessions per region where you will be out and about and an opportunity for divisions with their leadership teams their instructional leadership teams to be together right together to ideate to create

[00:50:45] and then of course just ongoing support and feedback from the video we help people get there again i think the board has been very articulate and a great partner to us to help us always realize this work is very hard and we want to be there to support them in whatever way we can our support is obviously ongoing so i will pause there for questions and comments i thank you for for your time, Madam President and board.

[00:51:17] - Are there any questions for Dr. Sorensen? How are there? - I'm really thrilled that we have a document where we can see all these plans. I think from your comments, it's really serving two functions, one of which is just to be transparent, let folks see the information on websites and what the plan is, but also to come alongside, and as I've heard Dr. Kuhn say many times, shoulder to shoulder and help our divisions get where they need to be.

[00:51:48] guess one thing that really stuck out to me in the feedback was the um mock-up great idea is that going to be part of the ig instructional guide or whatever no this is separate from the instructional guides the instructional guides are about the curriculum and about the standards this is about the implementation of vla and high quality instructional materials i got you sorry no problem we're doing a mock-up for them we will be walking them through a best practice guidance and through those implementation series so they will see a best practice lesson yes okay absolutely

[00:52:25] i mean i think you know it's tricky when you say describe and you give them a box like i'm all about like simplicity but you know i mean you guys know you can get one sentence or you get you know five pages so um the extent that you want to think about a minimum or maximum like they can't just write one sentence right you gotta have 500 words or whatever i mean this is just silly silliness but i'm just giving you some ideas to think about so you get high quality information but not onerous information um and then the uh my other just broad thing is in section five um so

[00:53:02] is there any reason not to just give them some labeling some of those when you do the drop downs there are some suggestions there for them like for example dr king is um very very serious and has had conversations with superintendents already around walkthroughs right that's one of the suggestions right as superintendents they should be walking through each of their buildings and really have an idea and their vision of what science-based literacy instruction looks like and so there are suggestions in some of those drop-down boxes and then other drop-down boxes

[00:53:38] don't have there's no drop down because we don't they may have something wonderful and creative already in place so we didn't want to give them every suggestion because they may have wonderful ideas already at their school mission that they're doing so there are drop downs and then there are fillings in other words sometimes like in section three they have to name the training name the audience name

the date and year in some cases five instead of a bunch of boxes in one of those boxes a drop down might be boxes is one example um professional learning community models is another

[00:54:15] Okay, so you are giving us some ideas. Okay, I'm all about flexibility. I'm just like, I'm looking at this going, what am I doing with these boxes, right? Okay, awesome. No, thank you. Is there anything further?

[00:54:35] just to thank you and really taking the feedback and gave this this really really solid process really high level of engagement yeah i appreciate it okay we have a motion to approve the content of the division literacy plan to comply with the virginia literacy act moved second mr sturdifant hi kilgore miss ashton hi dr siebert hi dr northern hi miss holton i can share both sides

[00:55:11] Okay. Before you all leave, thank you. Thank you. Madam H, first and final review of the College Laboratory Partnership School application from James Madison University. I believe this is you,

[00:55:27] Dr. Armstrong. Thank you. Madam President and board members, I am pleased to provide you with this overview of the James Madison University Lab School for Innovation and Career Exploration proposal, a partnership among James Madison University, Blue Ridge Community College, and the

[00:56:04] Superintendent's Region 5 School Division of Rockingham County for your consideration for approval today. I would like to first thank the members of the College Partnership Lab School Standing Committee, including our chair, Mrs. Joan Wadisca, Virginia Board of Education, members Mr. Billy Wotherham, and members Mr. John Bailey and Dr. Pam Moran for their time, their feedback, and their commitment to lab schools and the additional opportunities afforded by lab schools on behalf. Joining me today are Dr. Brian Zegelder, Associate Dean for Academic Affairs and Special Partnerships at James Madison University, Dr. Larry Shiflett, Superintendent

[00:56:41] of Schools for Rockingham County Public Schools, Dr. John Downey, President of Blue Ridge Community College, and Dr. Mark Westbrooks, Dean of the School of Education at James Madison University. Upon completion of my remarks, I will invite Dr. Zegelder and Dr. Shiflett to provide a brief overview of their proposal to introduce any other special guests representing the JMU Lab School for Innovation and Career Exploration.

[00:57:04] The whole of the JMU Lab School for Innovation and Career Exploration to provide career exposure to students through real-world problem-solving in collaboration with higher education professionals, pre-service college students, and industry experts on a responsive and flexible pathway to diverse areas of interest, education, health care, aviation maintenance, and public administration is responsive to regional workforce demands.

[00:57:29] Students remain enrolled in their homeschooling in Lickingham County Public Schools while being provided with several options to engage in career exploration, including dual enrollment opportunities at Blue Ridge Community College, one site coursework on campus at GMU, or at Massanutten Technical Center. Community problems of practice will guide the direction of curriculum, structurally administered in a hands-on environment, and includes simultaneous interdisciplinary teaching in public school staff, JMU faculty, and pre-service students, Blue Ridge faculty, and industry experts. Lab School would address multiple desirable and

[00:58:05] multiple desirable outcomes for students, future teachers, and regional schools, and students will be engaged in high-level applications, real-world problem-solving, while working closely with a team

of experts from both industry and the higher education partners. JMU Lab School will provide a space for innovation for educators, industry, and pre-service professionals to explore best practices in teaching and learning. Students will engage in a coursework in line with personal interest and region market demand industries and business and streamline that will therefore high-skill high-demand employment lab school jamie lab school application is notable

[00:58:45] for its goal to serve 200 students and reach enrollment of 600 students by getting the grant term which is representing the far highest enrollment of any proposed labs video we received the jamie application on august 22 2023 and in five months the agency has collaborated with the follows. During the week of August 29th, the BDOE subject matter guided feedback in each compliance related section of the application. All of the application review technical expert committee is to document the needed technical expertise, provide counseling to the applicants to identify and

[00:59:21] correct the implementation of the proposed lab school, determine compliance with state law regulation, highlight any potential problems or red flag expression, and identify aspects of the proposal that are especially exciting and unique. The subject matter team included myself, Mr. Rob Gilstrap for the Licensure and Leadership, Amy C. Pooch, Rebecca Askew and Ms. Melissa Velazquez, both from the Office of Policy, Dr. John Hendren from the Office of Faculty and Mr. Abelanza from the Office of Faculty Commons from the Department of Special Education and Student Services.

[00:59:59] Each VDOE subject matter expert was provided with the laboratory criteria checklist worksheet. areas of expertise were assigned to various staff subject to their education expertise at the VDOE. Placing these comments is included in the VDOE Completeness and Compliance Report, which corresponds to the lab school application and reflects the following dimensions of compliance.

[01:00:21] The executive summary, mission and vision, educational program, governance, management structure, financial obligations, placement. In addition to subject matter expert review, one-site technical assistance visit. Technical assistance visit was held on October 19, 2023, providing an opportunity for VDOE staff to engage in dialogue with the applicants related to application questions and to see the JMU facility preferences. The applicant was responsive to subject matter expert feedback and questions, provided edits to their application and addendums.

[01:00:56] Items that required attention by the applicant included verification of staffing scalability, specifically related to JMU pre-service, clarification of the lab schools' plans to administer the health and PE curriculum within their interdisciplinary instructional model, clarification of compliance with human resources requirements, additional detail related to the interdisciplinary instructional model and students' expansion of language related to sustainability.

[01:01:23] Responded with their edited application and a demo on November 12, 2023, which is subsequently reviewed by the subject matter experts the week of 2019. After further refinements included in JMU's December 15, 2020, the application was established that the applicant had provided satisfactory students to the ADOE, and the JMU Lab School application was posted in the First Standing Committee Review 2021. JMU Lab School for Innovation and Career Exploration was sent into the Standing Committee on January 8th and responded to questions that the JMU Lab School

[01:02:01] reported subsequently unanimously approved by the Standing Committee upon review consideration by you all, the Virginia Board of Education, today. JMU application was posted for public comment following the January 8th standing committee meeting on January 11th and remained available

until this morning, and no comment was. Half of the VDOE I submit that the James Madison University Lab School for Innovation and Career Exploration is compliant and ready to implement, and I recommend to the board that the lab school be approved and subsequently begin the contract approval process. To share more about the JMU Lab School, I am again joined today. It defines the

[01:02:37] Zugelder, additional information, introduce any other guests, and we have to answer any questions from the board. Thank you, Dr. Armstrong. Good morning. Madam President, Dr. Coons, all the members here, thank you so much for having us today. I'm Brian Zugelder, Associate Dean for Academic Affairs and Partnerships in the College of Education at James Madison University. So

[01:03:16] excited to talk with you today about the lab school application. And with me is Dr. Larry Shiflett, Rockingham County Public Schools Superintendent. I'd also like to acknowledge Dr. Mark Westberg's audience. He's Dean of the College of Education at JMU, a resident expert to lab schools, given all of his work in the past, which you will have seen his bio laid out in our application as well. And he's also representing President Albert's staff of JMU. I'd also like like to acknowledge Dr. John Downey, who is the president of Blue Ridge Community College. Dr.

[01:03:55] Downey has been a part of this process. He's been very committed to this partnership, so we're really excited to follow the partnerships. I really do need to thank Dr. Armstrong for his leadership. As you heard, August 23rd, day on the job, and he has been such an elite leader in this process and helping us get to this point. And also reiterate the standing committee's work.

[01:04:22] Ms. Wadiska, her leadership is just. It just has been impeccable and we really appreciate all the work that's done. So Dr. Armstrong did a great job telling you all about the Lab School, so we will just reiterate a few points. So our instructional model is designed to be different.

[01:04:41] We want school to look differently for students. We don't want it to be a traditional this time to this time you go to english from that time to that time you go to science we want it to be really interdisciplinary where english teachers are working together with healthy pe teachers where science teachers are working with english teachers and world geography teachers so during this half day model students will be a part of the lab school they will engage in project-based learning they will have fluid and flexible groupings english teacher may be working

[01:05:14] with a small group of students on one particular thing while the science teacher different group of students on something else so there will be whole group opportunities small group opportunities one-on-one opportunities in addition to the instructional team we have other big part of this process industry experts based on the community problems that we're trying to solve in Shenandoah Valley area. Also pre-service professionals, paraprofessionals, service

[01:05:49] teachers, pre-service counselors, social workers, people who are in public policy, public administration, and also those who are working on particular vocational and other professional areas from Blue Ridge Community College alongside faculty, both of those institutions. Lots of

[01:06:08] wraparound support for students. So for sustainability, I'm going to ask Dr. Melu to commit an opportunity to share a piece about our system in County Public Schools planning committee.

[01:06:34] Our board member is also present to share the board's commitment letter to take the process. Since we have some new board members come on board in January, I've met with them and there is a commitment in our school to engage in this partnership.

[01:06:54] it's the laboratory school with James Madison University in Blue Ridge community and we're committed to this in terms of using space in our buildings to teach the courses and the classes committed to providing the teachers prepared professionals when they're needed to serve our students who are in lab school and also a commitment to provide transportation for us like we can choose different pathways whether it's Blue Ridge Community College and making sure that all students have time there's a commitment from the school board as well as from the school

[01:07:32] to fully engage and participate in this lab school for the next five years so obviously in addition to that JMU is strongly committed to in-kind contributions that will occur naturally through personnel facilities space it should be noted that as of today JMU has invested 1.7 million dollars into this project uh to get this up and running blue ridge community college as well we are looking at ways of in-kind contributions through transportation

[01:08:12] supports from faculty all of the other values that are added to this process our corporate foundation relations amu is strongly behind this as well we see that as a great way to engage with industry. The connections with the Shenandoah Valley are just natural connections. It also is important for you to know that at JMU, the College of Education, the most externally funded college

[01:08:45] of all the colleges at JMU, we have received close to 11 million dollars each external funding, national grants state level grants local grants foundations and contracts and leveraging those existing funds is another way of bringing it so we're very excited about that and prepared to so we talked a little bit about those partnerships um we already have industry anxiously awaiting to uh us aviation being one of us a nice connection

[01:09:23] with Blue Ridge Community College as well. Of course, Blue Ridge Community College, we also have industries in our area that are ready and accessible, like Sentara Health, Merck, Purdue. We have a lot of industry right in our area.

[01:09:41] So we're very excited about that. And I believe that concludes our presentation. And we'll open this up for questions that you want. - Are there any questions from members of the board?

[01:09:59] - Terrific presentation. all obvious hard work that's gone up, however, I particularly applaud the career exploration focus that's going on in our high school students helps engagement with high school.

[01:10:16] I just want a clarification. This is a half day program, and is it going to be located at all of the high schools within Rockingham County? Justin Fields : Great question so in year one, it will start at East rockingham high school and broadway high school. Justin Fields : they're already preparing for the year one students and then it will expand to the other two high schools in rockingham spots would and turner ashby so by year two all four high schools will have this space a year five, we are.

[01:10:46] enrollment at 60. And so all of these students will have a model works without a transportation pattern because the students will still belong to their school for half the day and they'll be in the lab school for half the day. That's right. And they also will be able to take advantage of the extracurricular activities at their school and still be members of their school community. So it's a nice win-win compromise for all. Further questions or comments here. Dr. Northern. I was just going to say as a former CTE teacher for 36 years, I think

[01:11:26] this sounds so exciting. I hope it will be something that other parts of the state in the future will somehow learn to have the resources to incorporate out those. Dr. Northern. I'm just still trying to just understand the motto because I'm in the same camp that's super exciting. So it'll be available to all high school kids in in each of these high schools eventually so at the half a day like you finish your whatever fourth bell and then everybody is done halfway through the school day and goes to

[01:12:02] the lab school and they're going to pick one of these seven areas are these going to be pathways or they're going to be able to explore all seven of these things i guess i'm trying to figure out like is it is the idea to lead to an industry recognized credential or not is it just yeah so in ninth and tenth grade it's very exploratory it narrows down in 11th and 12th so in ninth and tenth grade depending on the community needs they will have um opportunities to connect as many industries as many pre-professional pathways as possible through this interdisciplinary approach

[01:12:37] so they might identify a problem that says you know in this area we want to work on solving clean water. So how do we do that by bringing in English, environmental science, Open PE, world geography to address those particular content areas while they're working with the industry.

[01:12:54] And the faculty from JMU and Blue Ridge plus the industry experts are all there as role models providing that content expertise, helping the teachers be better in understanding the content while also showing the students how to engage in that. That's the exploratory. When we get to 11th grade maybe throw that down a little bit they have a choice i want to focus on dual enrollment and start working on that associates or they come to jmu and say you know i want to dive deeper into education health and behavioral studies and so they'll be able to take classes there or they

[01:13:30] could say at this point i want to go back to just the traditional school model be a part of what other people are doing in my traditional model so during the ninth and tenth grade they will be in this lab school format for the half day the other half day they go right back into regular school who's the teacher who's teaching in the 9th and 10th grade versus the 11th so this is the benefit of rockingham partnership so the rockingham teachers will be identified and selected in partnership with the lab school and will be reassigned to lab school the other day they will

[01:14:09] also get a supplement from jmu because they'll be engaged in some additional planning professional development expectations we will have a different kind of performance appraisal for that time okay so jmu related for 50 percent and then the other 50 will be reassigned to teaching their traditional areas like they otherwise would in rockingham i'm sorry to get the model because it's very exciting and you guys have figured out a lot of the things that we've struggled with um the um

[01:14:44] credits how are they getting their credits like you know how how is that working yes so dr shift but if you want to chime in feel free so um they are required to address all the standards of learning for all the content so the content area teacher will still be responsible for documenting that all the standards of learning are met they will just be doing it differently um where you know when they're working with a group of students on one particular thing they might be solving this clean water issue but they're documenting how they're meeting standards of learning for english

[01:15:20] still responsible for completing the standards of learning assessments as applicable in addition to that we have built in a plan for alternative assessments that can be used performance-based assessments rockingham is already piloting this with world geography while also meeting the compliance standards of quality you're a junior and senior and you have to take four years of English. You're saying

that that half a day is where they're getting their English credits that they're required to have. That's right, in 9th and 10th. And then when they go to 11th and 12th grade, they will be meeting those English requirements as well, either through dual

[01:15:59] enrollment or their traditional model or at JMU. And the dual enrollment is being taught by the high school teacher who has received additional training in JMU to teach some of these higher level skills that may she may not be right so for dual enrollment yes and blue ridge has a great process already for ensuring the qualifications and training and selection of people for dual enrollment at jmu it will actually be jmu faculty who will be teaching courses so 11th graders will

[01:16:38] be sitting in classes with jmu professors teaching the classes thank you i'm sorry i had so many question that was a great question fascinating and you figured out a lot of i'd like to think outside of the box so thank you dr siebert i'm president uh yeah super excited and i i want to kind of build on location uh so clearly you're going to be something more at a competency-based

[01:17:07] approach than a cd time approach you can get food and obviously keep you called that um we obviously you know appreciated and visions that there's some flexibility about offices and versus seat time um it's not as explicit in some places as maybe we'd like it to be this board and and very interested in looking at high school redesign and long term so i think first of all there'll be opportunities for you all to inform that work as we take it on but also i would in my invitation i

[01:17:42] think that would be our whole invitation would be if you start to run into any regulatory issues related to this integration and this move to a case as we try to liberate ourselves from seat time and Carnegie units uh then please you know highlight those because again you'll be able to identify any and make a very compelling case differently we enthusiastically welcome uh and

[01:18:16] appreciate that invitation i think one thing that i would say is as much as you were providing a laboratory for our students you are also providing a laboratory for us as we move into sort of this new age of innovation and how we can how we can move on in that redesign effort uh miss holton this application is so detailed and it's really very rich and i appreciate that i am looking and this may be a question for dr armstrong and i'm sorry our lab school stem members aren't able to

[01:18:51] i do see in the financials that over the course of your zero through year five the total contract asking from the lab school fund of 11.3 million i thought it was a startup i thought the cap per school was five million yeah dr armstrong can probably clarify that but the startup um is separated out from the contract amount the startup is the one million ask and the years one through five is the per pupil expenditure and so there's some stipulations in the statutes on

[01:19:29] on those particular funds tapping into the um years one through five comes from the per pupil and i believe that there are funds in relative to that after november um the per pupil limit is

[01:20:08] that that threshold was developed using a statewide average of direct aid share that comes out to nine thousand five hundred seventy eight dollars per student so if you take the year-over-year ask of a lab school and you divide it by their enrollment this gets trued up of course every year based on their march enrollment reporting but if you take that overall ask and dollars and divide it they cannot exceed the number just with this application yes ma'am if i just so if i understand essentially some portion of those students per the state

[01:20:43] share of those students per pupil enrollment instead of going to the general rockingham county fund is going to the lab school actually that is all from the grant fund so this will not affect um any even though it's for people for people exactly exactly this is from the grass and that's another thing we've had to clarify this all comes from the grant fund it does not interfere with the stream that is going to be from our agency however we wanted to set that limit using the statewide. And that helps me understand the fund was a hundred million dollars in this biennium.

[01:21:21] That's correct. The law allows essentially to carry over that original hundred million to be spent in years two, three, four, five, six. Or the grant guidelines and yes so the funds have to be obligated by June 30th. You'll be seeing a lot of new between now and June 30th as we process through applications but yes of 175 million were designated for the operating funds uh 20 million for startup funds which jamie has also requested and actually that prompts i was going to ask you separately but i'll go ahead and ask

[01:22:01] can you give us some sense for our workload purposes i i who who else or or if you can name names how many other applications do you have pending that you expect us to see yes i'm immersed in this right now so i can absolutely give you names um right now we have several applicants who are in the review cycle at the agency level and that includes emery and henry here in the virginia community community central virginia community college university of virginia which is going to college i'm thinking i'm sorry off the top of my head i

[01:22:39] think that's where we are right now applications way i'm sorry yes mountain gateway actually had their first standing committee review we expect them to be in front of the standing committee for their second review in march that's six we have right now and then we have additional uh 10 we will have planning grants and we expect submissions in the next we have provided some deadlines for applicants because we make this process we're approval and submitted to our agency in february

[01:23:15] person wants to give us things we have worked to make that process as efficient as possible while still not this school the rockingham plan is to start in august of 24th is your expectation that those others eventually would be starting or would some of them be a year following i have received questions from some who would prefer considering the timing of this to start in 2025 and that is allowable i believe the language is a was hard to go to those who were starting in 2024 even 2023

[01:23:49] because when this initiative originally too we will have most starting in 2024 but some may need more time to open whether it's in the winter of 2025 any further questions i just want to thank dr armstrong and thank jmu i think jmu is in this process very early on and i think as lab schools are supposed to be the r d of what we can do and breaking the box as you guys said um so well joan

[01:24:26] wadiska has said over and over this is the r d space and we have the opportunity and i just you have persevered to create such an innovative opportunity it allows us really to think about high school redesign and i really appreciate you into this information um president creasy i hope we can bring others to learn from you as we're learning about things i appreciate it you know dr northern you've spoken several times about dual credit being worth school credit i think you have

[01:24:59] designed something that really meets very innovative opportunities while helping us think differently about high school in a way that i think is going to be nation-leading so i just want to thank all of you andy for shepherding this process but all of you for going along the process with us and really thinking creatively and excited that we've overcome transportation barriers allowing students to still feel

like they're a part of their community culture at their high school so i'm really really impressed at how you have really thought about all the details and sustainability

[01:25:30] so thank you so much for leading our way in k-12 education one more comment e to our planning few committees i mean full of 19 to their current thank you all okay and with that may i have a motion to waive first review and approve the jmu lab school application for a five-year period with

[01:26:05] annual reviews to delegate to the president and the superintendent final negotiation of the lab school contract including awarding a startup fund and up to 11 million 344 000 in per people funding from the college partnership laboratory school fund in accordance with the board's guidelines Ms. Kilgore, Ms. Ashton, Dr. Siebert, Dr. Norther, Ms. Holton, Ms. Holton, I'm the chair of the staff.

[01:26:39] Thank you very much, congratulations. Thank you very, very much.

[01:26:51] And with that the board is going to take about a 10-minute break please.

[01:27:05] okay welcome back everyone we need to go back to item d first review of the proposal to stagger

[01:42:27] the terms for early childhood advisory committee and in place of deputy superintendent of early education we have mr chapman here he is going to take over for miss conway so mr chapman take it it away. Thank you, President Creasy. Although you did ruin my opportunity to introduce myself as Jenna Conway, that might be the only time I was really able to do that. But President Creasy, members of the board, Superintendent Koons, yes, I'm here to fill in and brief you all on a proposal to stagger the terms for the Early Childhood Advisory Committee. As you know,

[01:43:04] the Early Childhood Advisory Committee is one of six advisory committees that the board has uh doing important work for it um in the field really getting into the details ecac as it's called the early child advisory committee um has been around since about 2021 and was formed under statute under chapter 14.1 of title 22.1 of the code of virginia and it's been really integral to a number of different projects that the board has seen over the years i might draw attention to the vqb5 plan the early childhood rating system revisions to general procedures and background

[01:43:40] checks when all of those regulations came over from the department of social services as these translated some major regulatory actions got right underway including these revisions that the early childhood advisory committee played a absolutely essential role in doing this work and more recently you recall seeing a nora a notice of intended regulatory action for revisions to the standards for licensed child day centers which will be moving to the proposed stage hopefully after public comment closes here at the end of the month so the challenge that the early childhood advisory committee is undergoing right now is since that committee was formed in feb and the

[01:44:20] appointment back in february of one all of the uh all of those those appointments are set to expire at the exact same time um at the end of this year and so since they're all uh you know set to expire that puts the work that the board is doing in a little bit of a precarious position um because there's there's huge risk of losing a lot of institution knowledge if all 22 members are being replaced at some time this could impede uh ecac's ability to vote to conduct business and also that places a large burden on staff in order to have to recruit for all two final teams

[01:44:58] this is the first of the three-year terms um you know under the board's bylaws committee terms are set for three years but then after that members can only serve two consecutive three-year terms So basically, this would be the last bite at the apple, and then no members would be re-eligible in 2027.

[01:45:18] So, you know, we would like to think proactively and figure out, well, how can we make sure that this problem isn't going to affect the work that committee is doing and the important board. So the proposal that we have for you here is to start staggering these terms now after these years, after this first year.

[01:45:40] And so the the idea would be to start breaking this up into phases, and so phase one, we would start seven to eight of the positions running on terms from July 1st, 2024 for June 30th of 2027 phase two, we would take another seven to eight appointments in those terms five that run the gate and in phase three, begin in July 1st, 2026 members holding the positions that aren't advertised in a given year if you're if you're kind of allow them to remain in

[01:46:15] in their positions and without having to reapply until the position. And the due or phase three begins. We do have standing advice. We're okay to do this from the Office of Attorney General.

[01:46:31] Positions were randomly selected, you know, to of which position would start. As you might recall that the early childhood advisory is controlled by statute in terms of the appointments and which of the appointments are required.

[01:46:47] So we've done our best to randomize which positions fall into which of the phases, with a couple of minor exceptions that I'll point out in the next slide. And if a position becomes vacant prior to the proposed date of advertisement, if someone is unable to continue in the expired term, then the plan would be to re-advertise and force contract end date with the appropriate phase.

[01:47:10] So here is the the plan for you of which which positions that are required by statute are going to begin in which phase. And i'll just highlight the two exceptions to the randomization. You know, the star next to the head start wider in phase one that's not school based.

[01:47:30] That is currently a position that is held by the the chair of the early childhood advisory committee. So, you know, that would benefit the committee, you know, in order for leadership was able to continue. And we've started in phase two, the two stars, the two asterisks for early change provider that is not funded is currently the vice chair. So we're hoping that that will allow

[01:47:55] But other than those two exceptions, this is a random distribution of these positions across the phases. And so the benefits of these term limits being staggered in this way, one, it will allow us to continue that we're ensuring membership representing across geographically, that we have like a wide range of geographical representation across the early childhood sector.

[01:48:26] It's certainly going to make sure that we establish reforms and conducting business using Robert's rules, and we hope that it's going to, besides our announcement of vacancy, allow us to stay on three two positions at one time, all the positions aren't going to be able to be dedicated to the same amount of thoroughness.

[01:48:46] Certainly, we hope that it's going to be under the same time. that's the the position the presentation for you um we do have this for first review so we expect that it will come back in march you

know for the board's full consideration um thank you so much mr chapman and so the board will take this item for first review and we will see you a wealthy

[01:49:20] miss conway in march instead of you um and so we can move on to our presentations and written reports i would just like to bring to the attention of the board the two reports that you see on the sharepoint site one i just felt like it was a good opportunity for us as a board to really review what the current standing committees are of the board and to get a good handle on how many members there are on each one of those standing committees and in addition to

[01:49:58] that sort of look at what their terms are as we talk about these different items like sort of our conversation about the advanced warning committee last month really prompted my desire for us to have this information so that we as a board can continue to keep our eyes and ears open for those that we may feel are suitable in taking over some of these roles on those committees if if we know people that we can reach out to um to to encourage them to to apply to be a part of

[01:50:37] those committees that's great and that's why we do have that particular item i here on the agenda and then additionally um i wanted to make sure that we were all clear on those dates that we had committed to because i know for for my purposes i need to make sure that i've gotten my dates all on my calendar appropriately for these um the ela public hearings that are coming up so just wanted to make sure that everybody had that at the top of mind too as we move into that um and mr chapman

[01:51:14] i do not want to catch you in an off uh moment here but i i just did want to have an opportunity for us to have a little bit of a conversation or at least just some information and maybe our council can help us with this too just that when we do have these public hearings and we have committed as board members to being there at those hearings we do need to honor that because we are i believe required to have in those public hearings particularly around the sols at least one member of the board is that correct i thought i thought that's what we said for

[01:51:50] history i could be wrong anyway uh this this is here for you um for you to be able to go back and just make sure that you are a part of that um and then i unless you have any comments on these two items um we have had um i've had the opportunity to meet with the elementary veterinary principles and bsba this week and they are very interested in our standing committees sharing their voice so as we're thinking about that they have asked that we reach out to their

[01:52:27] associations and make sure i know we did that with some of the work groups over the past year but just want to recommend that the board considers um those assistants being active and giving us feedback we actually met um last month with the elders and got feedback on the accountability piece so they have been active by the support so encourage everybody to consider those institutions any other comments on either of these two items just on one of the committees

[01:53:02] here is abtel the advisory board on teaching teacher education and licensure and i am the liaison the board liaison to abtel at least i have been serving in that role happy to share it with anybody else who's interested. And I just wanted to report that that's a very earnest, hardworking group, teachers and educators and ed prep program representatives, all sorts of PTA representatives, et cetera. And they had a meeting earlier this month where

[01:53:40] they've got a couple of significant proposals they are hoping to have ready to bring to us later this spring one suggestion i made to them one of the proposals i thought was interesting um and complex

and i suggested that when they bring it to us that they are bringing it to us you in in times past basically their recommendation comes to us in writing and um or somebody presents it but i was recommending especially when they've got something more substance going on they may want to come present to us at a work session and or come present

[01:54:15] on the agenda item and i certainly would second that because as much as we can see those people and put names with faces who are helping to serve the commonwealth by your service to our advisory committees we certainly want to hear from them and i think it might be a good opportunity perhaps in the future if we can get this on our agenda to you know from time to time hear from those chairpersons of those committees in order to just get a brief update right some i mean we get recommendations from them on a routine basis but adding programs etc we don't need them to be

[01:54:54] in person on but this was a this particular proposal i think is one that will be interesting to the board but it's complex and to have them present it and ask questions and understand and really in partnership with them on the content of the proposal. Absolutely. Dr. King? We could find those up with some of the work plan conversation yesterday. So you have one on teacher licensure in July that we proposed. We could definitely have the ABTEL come and do some

[01:55:26] presentation online. I think it would also just be helpful to hear exactly the purpose of those committees as well i mean abtel is now certainly an extremely active you know very in-depth uh and very critical piece of of the puzzle to the board and so i think that that would be a good opportunity for us to all hear about the integration of licensure and how all of that fits with ctps and

[01:56:01] you know particularly given that those several of us on this board are very very interested in you know looking at some opportunities we have in the licensure area um we should certainly hear from them as well this particular proposal i think they were hoping to finalize it at their february meeting and we're anticipating asking to bring it to us in march but it may well be that we could suggest have more time for you at our april meeting or some later time

[01:56:34] Dr. Morgan. Yeah, I mean this will reveal my my ignorance, but I don't know for are we also allowed to have temporary committees i'm just thinking as we move forward and trying to figure out how we're going to move quickly from a staffing base to a student based finance system for the state and what a process that's going to be.

[01:56:53] I think we could really use some expertise around the state around finance issues and again I don't know the process for trying to convene a temporary board. I imagine we might not need them for five or eight or 10 years, but maybe there's some other way we can get expertise as we have these conversations, but just a idea to throw out there.

[01:57:17] Yes, certainly. And any of these can be established by the president in consultation with the superintendent. We certainly have that opportunity. Anything else on either of these items before we move into this stuff?

[01:57:37] Does anyone have anything for that second of the agenda? I just thought I would note, again, as we've noted before, that the department's been working with building issues for the longer haul, and particularly this week, and I think they're back in the Monroe building today, the power is back on, so at least some of your staff are back there.

[01:58:06] um but we've all been reading in the newspaper about the longer term issues with monroe building and i just wanted to number one express sympathy to uh dr coombs and her staff as they're potentially going to be homeless or or and transition and transient and then ask you know i mean i don't know that it affects us that correctly but um you can be helpful or supportive and or yeah how might

[01:58:35] affect us and what's your sense of when you're going to be here. Dr. Keynes. Of course, I want to thank you for being so flexible and supportive coming here. I think on Tuesday when we weren't sure going back and forth, this board was incredibly supportive with being here, being a little bit of sorts with the tech. It's amazing that our tech people and that the Library of Virginia have provided. I just wanted to support. We called you all Tuesday night and we're all gracious and lovely and supportive and appreciate that.

[01:59:07] We do expect to be moving over the next year. We have experienced more interim problems than just the big problem on Tuesday, and our staff has been incredibly resilient, but it is time for us to have safe and secure, you know, long-term facilities.

[01:59:26] So we expect a phased move because moving 550 people at once is not productive in logistics management today. So as we learn more in our partnership with Department of General Services, we've been working very closely with them. I want to give a huge shout out to Jeremy Rayleigh, who is across the street at the General Assembly building today, but he has been working in close coordination with them to figure out how we move when we move. We hope to have that information emerge and we'd be more than happy to share that.

[01:59:55] But we are also working, as Elizabeth said earlier, on phase one, which is to be the digitization of records. A lot of our historic records are in boxes in places. And so Elizabeth has been the first one to take this on and kind of dig through all of our gifted records.

[02:00:14] But we are working with Dave and Diane Kernaghan, who you could not meet yesterday, and really thinking through our digitization process to make sure we're following responsibilities of records. but also modernizing the way we see the records. So phase one for us is the digitization process and making sure we digitize records.

[02:00:34] And then it will be thinking about personal space, how we want to work, or if we want to do more telework, how do we do that, how do we come together. We'll work into that plan, and then we'll be moving in a phased approach later this year. Thank you for that update.

[02:00:50] We'll keep you-- you've got a lot of challenge. It's one more thing on your very busy plate. is important to make sure our staff have good working conditions and that that is essential anything further as far as discussion i just want to thank the board i just want to thank the board we have had a lot of things um you talked about going out for english language arts standards we had a lot of board members out for collaboration the ability to partner together and work on important issues and i appreciate the collaboration on the work plan especially yesterday because it

[02:01:30] It really helps us, you know, what we want to do especially with the board, helps the team get collaborative. So my board asked, such as the lunch yesterday with the executive leadership team have been immensely helpful to my team, very positive. So we appreciate the ongoing partnership, thank you.

[02:01:49] - Anything else? I think just once again, thanks to the team for this shift. And we, I can't say I look forward to being back in the Monroe Building, 'cause I have personal issues around the elevators

there so that all of that being said, thanks to everyone who who made this possible in such an efficient manner and so with that if there is nothing else i'm not sure i'm beating my own record here today we're gonna have to keep tabs on that

[02:02:26] but that being said we are adjourned.